T-M-00550b (GSA-FSS)
March 29, 1967
INTERIM REVISION OF
Fed. Spec. T-M-550a
September 19, 1961

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

MOP, DUSTING, COTTON, UNIVERSAL

ACTION SWIVEL

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification T-M-550a, dated September 19, 1961.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a universal swivel action dry cotton sweep mop (handle, frame and mophead) primarily intended for use in dusting floors.

1.2 Classification

1.2.1 Classes. Mops covered by this specification shall be of one type and four classes, as specified:

Class 1 - 18 inches
Class 2 - 24 inches
Class 3 - 36 inches
Class 4 - 48 inches

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

V-T-276 - Thread, Cotton.
QQ-P-416 - Plating, Cadmium (electrodeposited).
QQ-Z-325 - Zinc Coating, Electrodeposited, Requirements for.
CCC-C-426 - Cloth, Cotton, Drill.
CCC-T-191 - Textile Test Methods.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

FSC 7920

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(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample approval. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1) before production is commenced, a sample of the mop to be supplied shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for examination and approval in accordance with 4.2. Approval of the preproduction sample authorizes commencement of production but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.2 Components. The mop assembly shall consist of a metal handle, a swivel action mop frame, and a cotton mophead.

3.2.1 Handle. The handle shall be of not less than 22-gauge cold-rolled tubular steel, with electric-welded seam or spotwelded at not less than each foot of the length of the handle, treated with a chromic-acid sealer, and coated with a baked-on enamel finish. The length of the handle shall be 60 inches ± 1/2 inch and the outside diameter shall be 7/8 inch. One end of the handle shall be covered with a handgrip of nonmarring material.

3.2.2 Swivel action connector. The swivel connector shall be of the design shown in figures 1A and 1B.

3.2.2.1 Frame. The frame shall be fabricated of steel bar stock, cylindrical in shape, which is either inherently corrosion resistant or cadmium or zinc coated. The overall length shall be 18, 24, 36, 48 inches ± 1/8 inch, as specified. The width shall be 5 inches ± 1/8 inch at the widest part and 3-3/8 inches ± 1/8 inch at the waist. The diameter of the frame shall be 1/4 inch ± 0.005 inch.

3.2.2.2 Handle sleeve. The handle sleeve shall be split and constructed of not less than 16-gauge cadmium or zinc coated steel or corrosion resistant steel. One end shall be formed to fit over the straight center portion of the S-swivel and bushing, and the opposite end formed to accommodate the handle. The overall length of the sleeve shall be 3 inches ± 1/16 inch. The tubular portion shall be 1-1/2 inches ± 1/16 inch in length and 7/8 inch ± 1/32 inch inside diameter, with two diametrically opposed vertical side openings. There shall be a hole approximately 3/16 inch in diameter through both walls of the sleeve. These shall be located 90 degrees from the side openings and approximately 3/8 inch from the sleeve end so as to mate with fastening holes in the handle. Assembly shall be accomplished with a 3/16 inch machine screw, lockwasher and capnut, or wingnut. All edges and surfaces shall be smoothly finished.

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3.2.2.3 S-swivel. The S-swivel shall be of cadmium or zinc-plated, annealed spring wire, 0.224 inch ± 0.004 inch in diameter, and tempered after forming. It shall be 3-3/8 inches ± 1/16 inch in length, measured after forming, and be constructed so as to permit a 360° swivel.

3.2.2.4 Bushing for S-swivel. The bushing shall be split and not less than 22-gauge, cadmium or zinc-plated cold-rolled steel, 1-3/16 inches long. It shall be designed to fit over the straight center portion of the S-swivel. A minus tolerance of 1/32 inch in the length dimension shall be permitted.

3.2.2.5 U-straps. A U-strap of not less than 16-gauge cold-rolled cadmium or zinc-plated steel, or corrosion resistant steel shall be placed over each end of the S-swivel and fastened in such a manner as to provide smooth and bind-free swiveling action. The U-straps shall be permanently secured to the bridge of the assembly with 3/16 inch tubular rivets.

3.2.2.6 Bridge. The bridge shall be constructed of not less than 18-gauge corrosion resistant steel or cadmium or zinc-plated cold-rolled steel. The bridge shall be 3-1/2 inches ± 1/8 inch wide (overall dimension after forming over frame) and not less than 3-3/4 inches long. The bridge shall be formed around the frame at the waist and shall be secured to the frame by spot welding or staking. The bridge shall be cut out in the center to permit free movement of the S-swivel and shall be reinforced by two E-shaped supports. The supports shall be fabricated of cylindrical steel bar stock 1/4 inch ± 0.005 inch in diameter securely welded to the underside. The end portions of the bridge shall be raised upward 1/4 inch by 1-3/4 inches in an embossed manner. The supports shall not extend beyond the bottom of the frame.

3.2.2.7 Braces. Each swivel mop frame and connector assembly, with the exception of the 18 inch size, shall include braces constructed of flat stock not less than 18-gauge cadmium or zinc-plated cold-rolled steel or corrosion resistant steel. There shall be two braces on the 24 inch size, four braces on the 36 inch size, and six braces on the 48 inch size. These braces shall be equally located between the bridge and each end of the frame. The braces shall be 3-7/8 inches ± 1/16 inch long and of sufficient width to measure 5 inches ± 1/8 inch after being formed around the frame. The end of the formed loop shall not have an opening greater than 1/8 inch. The braces shall be secured to the frame in a fixed position by spot welding or staking.

3.2.3 Metal Component parts. All metal component parts except the handle, which are not inherently corrosion resistant, shall be coated with cadmium or zinc having a thickness of not less than 0.0002 inch and shall show no evidence of corrosion when tested as described in 4.4.3. The thickness of the cadmium and zinc coating shall be determined as specified in QQ-P-416 and QQ-Z-325, respectively.

3.2.4 Mophead.

3.2.4.1 Mophead yarn. The mophead yarn shall be made from clean cotton containing not more than 5 percent of nonfibrous materials, and shall be of a suitable grade and staple to meet the following requirements:

Ply of yarn	4 ply
Yards per pound	Not less than 615 yards
Twist per inch of plied yarns	3 to 3.5 turns
Breaking strength (minimum)	12 pounds
Color of yarn	Natural or bleached

3.2.4.2 Thread. Sewing thread shall conform to the requirements of V-T-276, type IA1, 4 cord, ticket number 24 for sewing yarn and binding to body of mop. Bobbin thread shall be ticket number 40. Bartack needle thread and bartack bobbin thread shall be ticket number 40.

3.2.4.3 Drill cloth. The drill cloth used in the construction shall conform to the requirements of CCC-C-426, type I, class 2, except that the cloth shall not shrink more than one percent in the direction of the filling when tested as specified in 4.4 of CCC-C-426.

3.2.4.4 Tie tape. Tape for ties shall be a tubular braid of unbleached cotton yarn. The tape shall measure not less than 1/4 inch in width.

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3.2.4.5 Binding. Binding shall be of the same material as the mophead fabric or conform to type III, class 1, of CCC-C-426, and shall be cut on the bias.

3.3 Mophead construction. The mop assembly shall consist of a removable mophead. The mophead shall be made from two pieces of drill (3.2.4.3). One piece, forming the bottom, shall have three rows of self material not less than 3/8 inch wide, securely sewn thereto with a number 40 thread of a blue color before sewing on the yarns. Three rows of yarn shall be sewn with double needle stitching over the 3/8 inch strip and shall measure two inches from stitching on either side. The other piece, forming the top, shall have an opening for the insertion of the frame. The opening shall be bound. Mopheads for Class 1 mops shall have two ties and mopheads for Classes 2, 3 and 4 mops shall have four ties. The ties shall be at corresponding sides of the opening and shall be attached by means of bar tacking. Ties shall be cut approximately eight inches long. The two pieces of drill, top and bottom, shall be securely bound together around the edges, thus giving the appearance of a slipper. After binding together, an additional row of yarn shall be sewn around the edge. The yarns after being sewn to the bound sections shall be not less than four inches long on either side. The sweep (mop surface) of the finished mop shall measure not less than 13 inches in width, and not less than 26, 32, 44, and 56 inches in length for Classes 1, 2, 3, and 4 respectively. Length and width shall be measured from yarn tip to yarn tip.

3.4 Workmanship. The finished mop assembly or component part (when purchased separately) shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. When required, the preproduction sample submitted in accordance with 3.1 shall be inspected for all the provisions of this specification applicable to end product examination and tests.

4.3 Sampling and inspection. Sampling and inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated herein. For purposes of sampling, an inspection lot for acceptance inspection and tests shall consist of all complete mop assemblies or component parts (when purchased separately) of the same class offered for delivery at one time.

4.3.1 Visual examination. The required number of complete mops or parts shall be taken at random from the lot and examined in accordance with the classification of defects listed in table I. The sample unit for this examination shall be one complete mop assembly or component part, as applicable. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.5 major and 4.0 minor defects per hundred units.

TABLE I. Classification of Defects

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Handle	Not material specified.	X	
	Handgrip omitted.		X
	Handgrip not of nonmarring material.		X
	Holes in handle do not mate with holes in handle sleeve.	X	
	Not welded seam as specified.	X	

(continued)

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TABLE I. Classification of Defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Handle finish	Not baked-on enamel.	X	
Handle sleeve	Not material as specified.	X	
	Not slotted.	X	
S-swivel bushing	Not material as specified.	X	
	Not formed as specified.	X	
S-swivel	Not material as specified.	X	
	Not formed to permit a 360° swivel.	X	
U-straps	Not material as specified.	X	
	Do not permit bind-free swiveling action.	X	
	Not securely riveted to bridge.	X	
Bridge	Not material as specified.	X	
	Not securely affixed to frame as specified.	X	
	Not cut out in center.	X	
	Not reinforced by steel supports.	X	
	End portions not raised to receive supports.	X	
	Supports extend beyond bottom of frame.	X	
Braces	Number less than specified.	X	
	Not material as specified.	X	
	Not formed and positioned as specified.	X	
	Not securely affixed to frame.	X	
Frame	Not material as specified.	X	
	Not shaped as specified.	X	
Metal parts	Not material as specified.	X	
	Not rust free.	X	
	Not clean, evidence of oil or other foreign matter.		X
Mophead	Rancid or objectionable odor.		X
	Insect infestation.		X
	Spotted, soiled or stained.		X
	Specified number of ties omitted	X	
	Ties not bartacked.		X
	Ties not on corresponding sides.	X	
	Number of rows of stitching less than specified.	X	

4.3.2 Dimensional examination. The number of mops or parts taken for this examination shall be in accordance with inspection level S-2 of MIL-STD-105. The mops or parts examined shall be taken from the sample size in 4.3.1. The unit of product shall be one complete mop assembly or one part, as applicable, and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units. Any measurement not meeting the applicable requirements of section 3 shall be considered a defect. Where tolerances are not shown, industry tolerances shall apply.

4.3.3 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected

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at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or distortion of container.

4.4 Tests. The methods of testing as specified in CCC-T-191, wherever applicable, and as listed in table III shall be followed. The physical and chemical values specified in section 3 apply to the average of the determinations made on a unit or product for test purposes as specified in the applicable test method.

TABLE III. Test methods

Characteristics	Requirement Paragraph	Test Method
Yarn, Mop (plied):		
Yards per pound	3.2.4.1	4010
Breaking strength	3.2.4.1	4102
Twist (turns per inch)	3.2.4.1	4054
Nonfibrous Material	3.2.4.1	2611
Identification of cotton	3.2.4.1, 3.2.4.3, 3.2.4.4	1200
Frame assembly		
Corrosion resistance	3.2.3	Par. 4.4.3

4.4.1 Testing criteria. The sample unit for testing shall be as specified in subsidiary specifications and as follows:

Component	Lot size expressed as	Sample unit
Cloth, Cotton, Drill	Yards	3 yards full width.
Thread, Cotton	Bobbins, cones, or spools	A sufficient number to total a minimum of 360 yards. 1/
Yarn (mop)	Yards	40 yards. 2/ 3/
Frame assembly	Each (excluding handle and mophead)	As specified in 4.3.1.

1/ When thread is purchased on cones, spools, and bobbins, each shall be tested.
2/ Not less than 3 sample units from each lot shall be tested.
3/ Unless otherwise specified, five specimens shall be tested from each sample unit.

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4.4.2 Mop yarn. No sample unit test result shall fall below the minimum or above the maximum specified. The acceptable quality level for each characteristic shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units. The sample size shall be in accordance with inspection level S-2 of MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be expressed in units of 1 yard each.

4.4.3 Corrosion resistance test. The complete frame assembly, except if fabricated of stainless steel, and excluding the handle, shall be tested for corrosion resistance. Sample units selected in 4.3.1 shall be used for this test. The frame assemblies shall be placed in a boiling 10 percent (by weight) aqueous solution of sodium chloride for a period of 15 minutes. The frames upon being removed from the boiling solution shall be immediately immersed for at least one hour in 10 percent (by weight) aqueous solution of sodium chloride at room temperature. They shall then be removed from this solution and without having the adhering liquid wiped off, allowed to dry for 24 hours at room temperature and then wiped free of any residue and examined for presence of corrosion in compliance with 3.2.3.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Mopheads, handles, frames or mop assemblies. The mopheads, handles, frames or mop assemblies in sizes and quantities as specified in table IV (see 6.1) shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Cushioning shall be provided. The box shall be closed, waterproofed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Mopheads, handles, frames or mop assemblies. The mopheads, handles, frames or mop assemblies in sizes and quantities as specified in table IV (see 6.1) shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Cushioning shall be provided. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. The mopheads, handles, frames or mop assemblies shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2 Marking.

5.2.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

TABLE IV. Packing quantities for shipping container

Size	Mop Heads	Frames	Handles	Complete Assemblies	
18	12	12	12	12	
24	12	12	12	12	PACKING
36	12	12	12	6	Quantities
48	12	6	6	6	

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Class of mop required (see 1.2).
(c) Whether preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).
(d) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) Quantities of mopheads, frames, handles, or complete assemblies required in shipping containers (see 5.1.1 and 5.1.2).

6.2 When level B packaging requirements are specified for civil agency procurements, the requirements of 5.1.1 shall apply.

6.3 Illustration. The illustrations shown herein as figures 1A and 1B is for the purposes of illustrating the general design and is not intended to preclude any mop frame which otherwise meets the requirements of this specification.

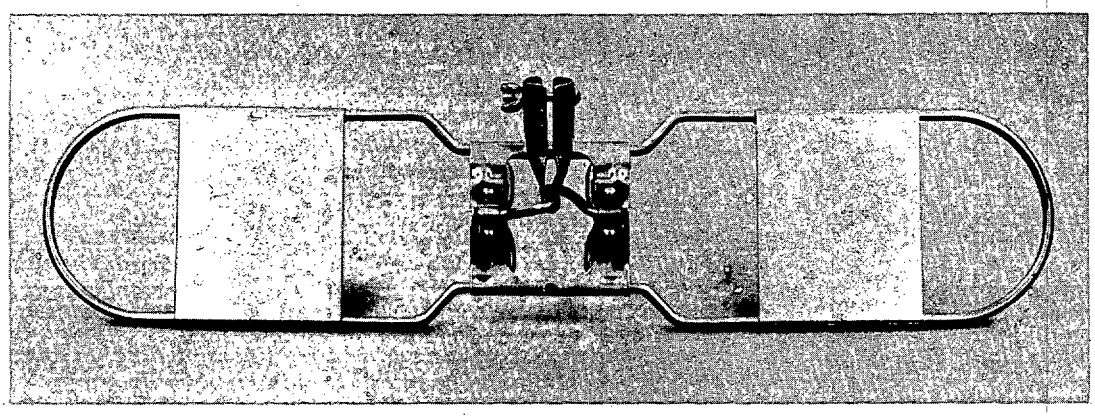


Figure 1A. Top View

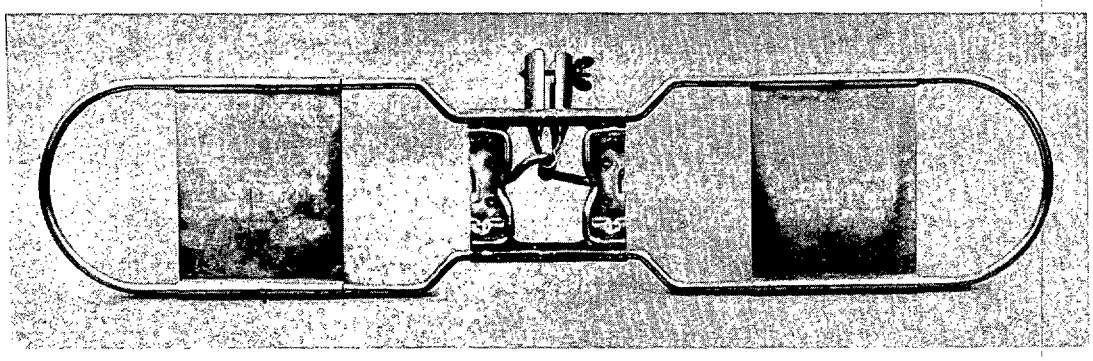


Figure 1B. Bottom View

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